

USER GUIDE

DigiRoutes

Share your exact doorstep.

What it is	A free Android app and website that turn a place in India into a short DIGIPIN code and let you save, share and find exact doorsteps with entrance photos, delivery notes and private QR links.
App version	1.6.0 (Android)
Get the app	github.com/kushkumarkashyap7280/digiroutes_app → Releases → latest digiroutes-vX.Y.Z.apk
Website	https://digiroutes.vercel.app — works on any phone or computer
Cost	Free

New here? Read section 3 (Quick start) — your first address card takes about two minutes. Received a link or QR code from someone? Jump to section 7.

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1. What is DigiRoutes?

A normal address like "near the blue gate, behind the temple, 2nd lane" is easy to misread. Delivery people, guests and cab drivers lose time finding the *exact* door.

DigiRoutes fixes this with two ideas:

- **DIGIPIN** — a short 10-character code (for example `39J438TJC7`) published by India Post. Every ~4 m × 4 m square in India has its own code, so the code points to a doorstep, not just a street. It works anywhere in India.
- **Address cards** — a DIGIPIN plus everything a visitor needs: **entrance photos**, a **delivery note** ("ring twice, call before entering"), a **phone number** and a **QR code**.

You create a card once, then share it through a **private link or QR code**. Whoever opens it sees the photos, the note and a map, and can tap **Navigate** or **Call**.

You are...	You can...
A resident or shop owner	Save your door as a card and share the link or QR with guests, couriers and customers.
A visitor or delivery person	Open a link, scan a QR or type a code → see the entrance photo and note → navigate.
Just curious	Use the free DIGIPIN tools and the route planner.

2. Get the app

DigiRoutes is available for **Android**. (There is no iPhone app yet — iPhone users can use the website.)

2.1 Install

1. On your Android phone open https://github.com/kushkumarkashyap7280/digiroutes_app/releases/latest.
2. Under **Assets** tap the file named `digiroutes-vX.Y.Z.apk` (the numbers are the version). It is about 75 MB, so use Wi-Fi if you can.
3. When the download finishes, open it. If Android asks, allow your browser (or file manager) to **install apps from this source**, then tap **Install**.
4. Open **DigiRoutes**. Allow **location** and **camera** when asked — see section 10 for why.

"Blocked by Play Protect?" DigiRoutes is installed from GitHub rather than the Play Store, so Android may show an extra warning. Choose **Install anyway** / **More details** → **Install anyway**.

2.2 Updates

When a new version is out, the app shows **Update available** when you open it. Tap it to download and install — your account and cards stay as they are. You can also check manually: **Menu (≡) → Settings → Check for updates**.

2.3 Create your account

1. Swipe through the three intro slides and tap **Get Started**.
2. Choose **Sign up** and enter your **name**, **email** and a **password** (at least 6 characters; longer is safer).
3. You stay logged in, even after closing the app or going offline, until you choose **Log out**.

3. Quick start — your first card in 2 minutes

1. Stand at your door (or the place you want to share).
2. Tap the round orange **+** in the middle of the bottom bar. The app finds your **location automatically** and shows your DIGIPIN.
3. Type a **title** (for example "Home — Gate 2") and add a **photo** of the entrance.
4. Tap **Save**.
5. Open the card → tap **Share** or the **QR** icon → send it to whoever needs it.

That's it. The sections below explain each step in detail.

4. Finding your way around the app

The bar at the bottom has five places:

Tab	What it does
Home	A full-screen map. Tap Get My DIGIPIN to see the code for where you are now — copy it or share it. The search bar opens Where to? (section 8).
Scan	Open a card from a QR code or a typed code (section 7).
+	Create a new address card (section 5).
Cards	All the cards you made, with search and filters.
Compass	DIGIPIN tools: find your code, turn a code into a map position, or turn coordinates into a code. <i>(It does not show a magnetic compass needle.)</i>

The **≡ menu** (top-left) holds your **Profile**, **Settings**, **Share DigiRoutes** (send the app to a friend) and **Log out**.

Shortcuts: press and hold the DigiRoutes app icon on your home screen to jump straight to **New card here** or **Scan QR**.

5. Address cards

5.1 What a card holds

Field	Notes
Location / DIGIPIN	Taken from your GPS when you create the card. It cannot be changed afterwards — a different place needs a different card.
Title	Required. For example "Home", "Shop — Main Road".
Address	Optional text such as the street or landmark.
Photos	Up to 2 entrance photos, 4 MB each. Take them with the camera or pick from the gallery.
Category	Home · Work · Shop · Family · Other.
Delivery note	Up to 300 characters, e.g. "Ring twice. Call before entering."
Contact phone	Optional. Visitors can Call or message on WhatsApp .

Tip for good photos: photograph the gate or door from the street, so a stranger recognises it at a glance. The delivery note is the place for "second floor, green door".

5.2 Managing your cards

- **Search** by title, address or DIGIPIN, and use the chips to show **All**, **Favorites** or one category. The search covers *all* your cards, not only the ones on screen.
- **Favorite** a card with the ★ — favorites float to the top.
- **Long-press** a card for quick actions: favorite, edit, share, QR, delete.
- **Edit** changes the title, photos, note, category or phone. **Delete** removes the card **and its photos** for good.
- Cards load 12 at a time; keep scrolling for more.

5.3 Opening a card

Tap a card to see the photos, DIGIPIN (tap to **copy**), note, map and these buttons:

- **Navigate** — opens Google Maps with turn-by-turn directions.
- **Call** and **WhatsApp** — shown when the card has a phone number that is not hidden.
- **QR** and **Share** — pass the card on (section 6).

6. Sharing a card safely

6.1 Why you need a private link

A DIGIPIN is **not a secret** — anyone can work out the code for a place. So DigiRoutes never shows your photos, note or phone number just because someone knows your DIGIPIN. A card opens only for people who have its **private link** (or the QR that contains it).

Each card has its own link, like <https://digiroutes.vercel.app/c/Qw3rT...> — long and random, so it cannot be guessed.

6.2 Ways to share

- **Share** — one tap sends a single message with the photo, DIGIPIN, address, note, phone, a Google Maps link and the private link. Send it through WhatsApp, SMS, email — anything.
- **QR code** — open the card and tap the QR icon. Show it on your screen, send it as an image, or **print it** and stick it near your gate or on your visiting card. Anyone who scans it lands on your card.
- **Copy link** — paste it anywhere.

6.3 You stay in control

Open your card and find **Share with a link**:

Setting	What it does
Sharing on / off	Off makes the card completely private. The QR code is hidden while sharing is off.
Reset link	Creates a brand-new link. Old links and QR codes stop working — use this if a link reached someone it shouldn't have.
Expiry	Never · 24 hours · 7 days. Handy for a one-off delivery or a weekend guest.
Hide my phone number	Visitors still see the photo and note, but no Call / WhatsApp buttons.
Opened N times	How many times the link has been opened.

When a link is switched off, expired or reset, visitors see the same message — **"This link isn't available"** — so nobody can tell which links ever existed.

Heads-up: anyone holding an active link can see what is on the card — including the phone number and note, unless you hide the phone. Only put on a card what you are happy to share with the people you send it to. And remember a link can be forwarded; reset or expire it whenever you like.

7. If someone sent you a link or QR

You do **not** need an account to open a shared card.

- **Tap the link** (in WhatsApp, SMS, a browser...). If DigiRoutes is installed it opens in the app; otherwise it opens on the website. On Android the website also offers an **Open in app** banner.

- **Scan a QR** — open the **Scan** tab in the app and point the camera at the code. A torch button helps in the dark.
- **QR is on this same phone** (a screenshot or saved image)? In the Scan tab choose **From gallery** and pick the image.
- **Only have the code or text?** Choose **Type code** and paste the link or DIGIPIN.

You'll see the entrance photo, the note and a map. Tap **Navigate** to drive or walk there, or **Call** the owner.

The camera runs only while the Scan tab is open, and QR codes are read on your phone — the camera picture is never sent anywhere. A QR code that isn't from DigiRoutes is rejected.

8. "Where to?" — route planner

On **Home**, tap the search bar.

1. Choose a **start** and a **destination**. Each can be: - your **current location**, - one of **your saved cards**, - a **DIGIPIN** or **DigiRoutes link**, - **coordinates** such as **28.61, 77.20**, - a **scanned QR code**, - a **place name** (for example "India Gate").
2. See the route on the map with the **road distance** and **travel time**. Switch between **drive**, **bike** and **walk**.
3. The **straight-line distance** is always shown, even offline.
4. Tap **Navigate in Google Maps** for turn-by-turn directions.

If the route service is busy or you're offline, you still get the straight-line distance and a clear message.

9. Using the website

Visit <https://digiroutes.vercel.app> on any phone or computer — no download needed.

- **DIGIPIN converter** — turn coordinates into a DIGIPIN, or a DIGIPIN back into a position, with a map and a Google Maps link.
- **Your dashboard** — sign up or log in with the same account as the app to create, edit and delete cards in a browser. Cards you make in the app and on the website are the same cards.
- **QR codes** — generate a printable QR "pass" for a card or location, and scan QR codes with your device camera.
- **Shared cards** — links of the form **/c/...** open a card for anyone who holds the link.
- **Light and dark themes**, and you can install the site to your home screen like an app.

10. Your account, privacy and settings

10.1 Profile and settings

- **Profile** (≡ menu): add or change your **profile picture**, change your **name**, and see how many cards and favorites you have. Your email is shown but can't be changed.
- **Settings**: choose **Light**, **Dark** or **Auto** (follows your phone), turn **sound and haptics** on or off, **check for updates** and see your app version.
- **Log out** is at the bottom of the menu and always asks you to confirm.

10.2 Permissions — what and why

Permission	Why
Location	To fill in your position when you create a card and for Get My DIGIPIN and "current location" routes. Not needed to open shared cards.
Camera	To scan QR codes and to take card or profile photos.
Internet	To save cards, load photos and get routes.
Install apps	Only to install a DigiRoutes update you approve.

If you deny a permission the app keeps working; only the matching feature is unavailable until you allow it in Android settings.

10.3 What happens to your data

- Your password is never stored in readable form, and your login is kept in Android's secure storage on your phone.
- Photos you upload are stored securely online so that people with your link can see them. If you replace a photo, delete a card or delete your account, **the images are deleted too**.
- Your cards are visible only to you, and to people you give a private link to. A DIGIPIN alone never reveals them.
- A cached copy of your name and picture lets the app open even without internet. Being offline never logs you out.

10.4 Delete your account

≡ **menu** → **Settings** → **Delete account**. Enter your password to confirm. This permanently removes your profile, **every card, all photos and your profile picture**, and logs you out everywhere. It cannot be undone.

11. Troubleshooting and FAQ

The app won't install. Allow "install from this source" for your browser or file manager, and choose **Install anyway** on a Play Protect warning (section 2.1). Make sure there is enough free space — the app is about 75 MB.

"Update available" won't install over my old app. Updates only install over apps that came from DigiRoutes releases. If an old test version is installed, uninstall it first and install the latest one (cards are stored online, so you can log in again to get them back).

It says "This link isn't available." The owner switched sharing off, the link expired, or they reset it. Ask them to send a fresh link.

The scanner doesn't read my QR. Hold the phone steady about 15–25 cm away, turn on the torch in dim light, and make sure the whole code is in view. If the QR is in a screenshot, use **From gallery**. Check that camera permission is allowed.

"Get My DIGIPIN" or "+" can't find my location. Turn on location (GPS) and allow the permission. Indoors, step near a window or outside for a moment — GPS can be weak inside buildings.

It says my location is outside India. DIGIPIN covers India only; outside it the app shows an error instead of a code.

Photo won't upload. Photos must be under **4 MB** and you can add **2** per card. Try a smaller image, and check your connection — uploads can take longer on slow data.

"No internet connection" or "Server is taking too long". Check your connection and try again. Your login is not lost when you're offline.

I forgot my password / my account was reset. Ask the person who runs your DigiRoutes service (for the project team, see section 12) — an administrator can reset it and give you a temporary password to sign in with. Don't post account details in a public issue.

Why is the code a few metres off from where I stood? A DIGIPIN names a ~4 m square. Decoding returns the square's centre, so expect about 2–3 m of difference.

Does it work for places outside India? No — DIGIPIN is an India Post standard. The map and route planner still work elsewhere, but DIGIPIN features are for India.

Is it free? Yes. The app, website and all their features are free.

12. Help and feedback

- Report a problem or suggest an idea: open an **issue** at https://github.com/kushkumarkashyap7280/digiroutes_app/issues.
- Latest app and release notes: https://github.com/kushkumarkashyap7280/digiroutes_app/releases/latest.
- Website: <https://digiroutes.vercel.app>.

DigiRoutes is a student minor project. DIGIPIN is an open standard of India Post (Department of Posts, Government of India); DigiRoutes is not an official India Post product.